

KASHMIR & LADAKH

Karan Mahal, Srinagar

A 19th-century private residence restored into a luxurious modern homestay, the European-style villa of Karan Mahal is located at the foot of the Shankaracharya Hill with a glorious 360-degree view of the mountains. The vast private orchard leading to the popular Dal Lake is a study in what makes Kashmir a paradise on earth. You can soak in the magnificent sights from all seven guestrooms here, or journey to a bygone era through the interiors furnished with vintage Kashmiri carpets, crystal chandeliers and art deco furniture. The food too is a delight—home-cooked and drawn from age-old royal recipes.

From Rs 32,000
www.karanmahalsrinagar.com

Chospa Hotel, Leh

The once remote town of Leh may have become a bustling tourist hub now, yet there are places here that offer a glimpse of the otherworldly aura of the Leh that once was. One such is the Chospa Hotel, located in the heart of town, with an architecture that reflects vernacular Ladakhi style and materiality such as compressed earth walls. The entire property has a serene oasis vibe to it despite being in the heart of town, while the in-house restaurant Juniper offers international dishes with traditional Ladakhi elements and Tibetan flavours.

From Rs 15,900
www.chospahotel.com

The Kyagar, Nubra Valley

Nestled in a jaw-dropping setting amidst the Karakoram mountains on the ancient Silk Route, The Kyagar is a socially responsible, community-driven and family-owned eco lodge. It's all about sustainability and self-reliance, with solar power and locally-grown food. You can visit a 250-year-old aristocratic home in the Kyagar village that remains untouched by modernisation or enjoy some birdwatching in this biodiverse crossroads of four zoogeographic zones. The region is also one of the best dark sky environments in the world, and stargazing with the resort's telescope is just the way to wind up the nights.

Tariff on request
www.thekyagar.com

GLAMPING IN GEODESIC DOMES

In recent years, geodesic domes have popped up across the hills around the country. Built of a network of interconnected triangular panels forming an igloo-like shape, these domes offer customisable accommodations for glamping, with a unique blend of comfort and stunning mountain views in a sustainable and weather-resistant structure.

- Avalon Cottages near Kanatal in Uttarakhand offers domes with stunning views of the rolling mountains and deep valleys of the Garhwal Himalayas, with the lush Kaudia forest around. *www.avaloncottages.com*



- Glamping Club near Manali in Himachal Pradesh is a cluster of luxury domes that offers a private jacuzzi in a peaceful secluded setting. *www.glampingclub.in*

- In Kerala, Luxeglamp, as the name suggests, offers glamping in domes with wooden patios, hot tubs, saunas and other such luxe amenities.

www.luxeglamp.com

